 **Library Committee**

This committee considers all matters relating to library of the Parliament and assists the members in utilising the library's services. It consists of 9 members (6 from Lok Sabha and 3 from Rajya Sabha).

 **Joint Committee on Salaries and Allowances of Members of Parliament**

This committee was constituted under the Salary, Allowances and Pension of Members of Parliament Act, 1954. It consists of 15 members (10 from Lok Sabha and 5 from Rajya Sabha). It frames rules for regulating payment of salary, allowances and pension to members of Parliament.

CONSULTATIVE COMMITTEES

Consultative committees are attached to various ministries/departments of the Central Government. They consist of members of both the Houses of Parliament. The Minister/Minister of State in charge of the Ministry concerned acts as the chairman of the consultative committee of that ministry.

These committees provide a forum for informal discussions between the ministers and the members of Parliament on policies and programmes of the government and the manner of their implementation.

These committees are constituted by the Ministry of Parliamentary Affairs. The guidelines regarding the composition, functions and procedures of these committees are formulated by this Ministry. The Ministry also makes arrangements for holding their meetings both during the session and the inter-session period of Parliament.

The membership of these committees is voluntary and is left to the choice of the members and the leaders of their parties. The maximum membership of a committee is 30 and the minimum is 10.

These committees are constituted after a new Lok Sabha is constituted, after General Elections for the Lok Sabha. In other words, these committees shall stand dissolved upon dissolution of every Lok Sabha and shall be reconstituted upon constitution of each Lok Sabha.

In addition, separate Informal Consultative Committees of the members of Parliament are also constituted for all the Railway Zones. The members of Parliament belonging to the area falling under a particular Railway Zone are nominated on the Informal Consultative Committee of that Railway Zone.

[1]A joint committee consists of members of both the Houses of Parliament.

[2]The Railway Convention Committee, 1949 was the first Committee after independence. This Committee and subsequent Committees confined themselves to determining the Rate of Dividend payable by the Railways to General Revenues. Since 1971, the Railway Convention Committees have been taking up subjects which have a bearing on the working of the Railways and Railway Finances.

[3]Ashok Chanda: *Indian Administration*, George Allen & Unwin Ltd, London, 1967, p. 180.

[4]In 1989, three DRSCs were constituted which dealt with Agriculture, Science & Technology and Environment & Forests. In 1993, they were superseded by the Department-Related Standing Committees (DRSCs).